Summary of Teaching Evaluations

Alain Maubert Crotte

The following is a summary of student evaluations from courses taught across the Faculty of Science and the Faculty of Media, Art, and Performance. Across all courses, my goal is to create an interactive, rigorous, and supportive learning environment.

Overall Highlights

- **Creative Technologies & Design:** In **CTCH / DES 312: Introduction to Computer Game and VR Design**, student evaluations averaged **4.3 out of 5.0**, and in **CTCH 223: Building Interactive Gadgets**, they averaged **4.2 out of 5.0**. Students consistently highlighted the instructor's approachability, respect for students, and ability to make complex topics accessible.
- **Foundational Computer Science:** Historical evaluations in **CS 215: Web and Database Programming** averaged between **2.6 and 3.0 out of 4.0**, reflecting solid foundational instruction in early-career courses.
- **Hands-On Engagement:** In physical computing labs (**CS 207: Building Interactive Gadgets**) and upper-level project courses (**CS 476: Software Development Project**), qualitative feedback strongly praised the interactive, hands-on nature of the labs and the real-world experience of the final software projects, even where overall summary metrics were not formally generated.

Selected Student Feedback

On Practical, Hands-On Learning

> *"I found the software project itself the most useful, it is great experience."* — **CS 476**

> *"The layout of building a project from start to finish was very useful since it will show the students what it will be like when they have jobs in the IT sector."* — **CS 476**

> *"Having a whole semester to think of a problem and make a solution for it was a great way to get experience coding outside of a single person environment, as well as applying what we have learned so far in the degree to something that actually has a final result."* — **CS 476**

> *"The practical thing, It is an opportunity to apply the theoretical concepts in a practical way."* — **CS 207**

> *"The lab period allowing us time to set up the arduino during the lab period, and to ask questions when things don't work properly. Independent work*

and following schematics helps to solidify understanding of components.” — **CS 207**

“The application of course material and ‘figuring it out’ facilitates learning for the class.” — **CS 207**

“I learned a lot from the lab on how to do the connections and program it.” — **CS 207**

“The labs itself were great... Otherwise, I did learn a lot from this course and I found wiring to be pretty fun!” — **CTCH 223**

On Classroom Engagement and Teaching Style

“The instructor shows live examples of various code as well as present fun activities which are helpful in learning the coding concepts in a very easy manner. I would certainly take another course with this instructor if the opportunity rises.” — **CS 215**

“The instructor was awesome. The in class activities we did were an excellent way to get us to learn the material.” — **CS 215**

“Professor Maubert is very good at getting the class engaged in activities to help us learn which is a great teaching style to have.” — **CS 215**

“Strength: encourages class participation and critical thinking” — **CS 215**

“He is very enthusiastic.” — **CS 215**

“The instructor engages the class which I like, and the project itself was pretty cool to do” — **CS 476**

“Being added into breakout rooms for small group projects. Helped keep me understanding what was going on.” — **CS 476**

“After demonstrating we are left to work in the lab ourselves and complete it. It is helpful to watch then do it on your own as it facilitates for both visual and auditory learners as well as ‘do it yourself’ learners” — **CTCH 223**

On Instructor Approachability and Care

“Friendly, approachable, respectful, and capable instructor. Course is enjoyable and useful. Thank you!” — **CTCH / DES 312**

“He has a good grasp of the course and willing to help student.” — **CTCH 223**

“He is friendly, helpful and caring.” — **CS 215**

“He is available and willing to help” — **CS 215**

“He just wants you to know the subject, he is always ready to explain” — **CTCH / DES 312**

“The best professor in the world! (from the bottom of my heart)” — **CS 476**

Areas of Growth and Reflective Practice

I actively review student feedback to improve my course delivery and curriculum design.

- **Lecture Delivery and Pacing:** Early feedback in foundational courses (CS 100, CS 215) noted that the dense volume of material sometimes felt challenging to absorb within the class period. I have since heavily revised my approach, shifting focus toward live coding demonstrations and interactive problem-solving to break up the lecture format and enhance engagement.
- **Curriculum Modernization:** Feedback has highlighted the importance of using current industry tools. I have transitioned course materials to focus on modern pipelines (e.g., Unity and current VR SDKs) rather than legacy software.
- **Balancing Theory and Practice:** In **CTCH / DES 312**, while students appreciated the theoretical depth, some requested more foundational Unity tutorials before the final project. In response, I provided supplementary Unity documentation to support their technical learning and extended project deadlines when I observed students struggling to balance the workload.
- **Group Work:** While many students appreciated collaborative activities, some expressed a preference for independent work. I now offer a mix of individual and group assessments where possible to accommodate different learning styles.